

WEEK 05 / GAMING'S IMPACT ON PEOPLE AND SOCIETY

Representation, Inclusion, and Accessibility

Analyzing representation and inclusivity in gaming.

This week we analyze representation and inclusivity in gaming, discussing how different groups are portrayed and the efforts to create a more inclusive gaming environment, including the role of features that make games more accessible to all players. This includes assistive technologies and design principles. We will also take a look at character design, storylines, representation among the game development community, and community dynamics.

33 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC**TOPIC 01**

Representation and Inclusion

REQUIRED**Tropes vs. Women in Video Games****YOUTUBE PLAYLIST | 12 MIN**https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLn4ob_5_ttEaZWlYcx7VKiFheMSEp1gbq

Tropes vs. Women in Video Games (83 min) or [The Lady Sidekick \- Tropes vs. Women in Video Games

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED**The gaming industry needs more women developers****ARTICLE | 4 MIN**<https://moonshot.news/news/diversity-inclusion/the-gaming-industry-needs-more-women-developers/>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED**Inclusive Character Creator****YOUTUBE | 18 MIN**https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FPJQk88G8Ks&ab_channel=GameDevsofColorExpo

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

The Power of Play: The Portrayal and Performance of Race in Video Games

BOOK EXCERPT | 63 MIN

https://com427spring2017ncsu.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2017/01/2007-everett_watkins-powerofplay-raceingames.pdf

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

The Video Game Industry's Problem With Racial Diversity

ARTICLE | 5 MIN

<https://www.newsweek.com/2016/10/21/video-games-race-black-protagonists-509328.html>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

GDC 2024 Report: More Of The Same...

ARTICLE | 3 MIN

<https://www.womeningames.org/gdc-2024-report-more-of-the-same/>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

Beyond Solitaire Podcast 103: Adrienne Shaw on LGBTQ+ Representation in Video Games

YOUTUBE | 54 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3qFptT--lC0&ab_channel=BeyondSolitaire

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

The history of LGBTQ representation in video games

ARTICLE | 11 MIN

<https://outinjersey.net/the-history-of-lgbtq-representation-in-video-games/>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

How the first LGBTQ+ video game was given a second life

ARTICLE/TRANSCRIPT | 5 MIN

<https://www.npr.org/2023/01/27/1151702216/how-the-first-lgbtq-video-game-was-given-a-second-life>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

Video game creators are working to make games more accessible for disabled people

[AUDIO/TRANSCRIPT](#) | 6 MIN

<https://www.npr.org/2024/06/09/nx-s1-4995567/video-game-creators-are-working-to-make-games-more-accessible-for-disabled-people>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

REQUIRED

Another World Conquered by Video Games: Retirees

[ARTICLE](#) | 8 MIN

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_proquest_newspapers_433527823

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Gaming Representation: Race, Gender, and Sexuality in Video Games ed. by Jennifer Malkowski and TreaAndrea M. Russworm, and: Woke Gaming: Digital Challenges to Oppression and Social Injustice ed. by Kishonna L. Gray and David J. Leonard

[REVIEW](#)

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_crossref_primary_10_1353_cj_2020_0052

EXPLORE FURTHER

Game Devs of Color Expo Website

[WEB SITE](#)

<https://www.gamedevsofcolorexpo.com/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Game Devs of Color Expo YouTube Channel

[YOUTUBE CHANNEL](#)

<https://www.youtube.com/@GDoCExpo>

EXPLORE FURTHER

LGBTQ Video Game Archive

[WEB SITE](#)

<https://lgbtqgamearchive.com/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Pac-Man Was Developed With Women in Mind

ARTICLE

<https://www.cbr.com/pac-man-created-for-women/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Woke Gaming : Digital Challenges to Oppression and Social Injustice

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1i25tbk/alma991033681649708681

Woke Gaming : Digital Challenges to Oppression and Social Injustice edited by Kishonna L. Gray and David J. Leonard

EXPLORE FURTHER

Gaming Representation: Race, Gender, and Sexuality in Video Games

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1i25tbk/alma991046438239708681

Gaming Representation: Race, Gender, and Sexuality in Video Games by Jennifer Malkowski and TreaAndrea M. Russworm

EXPLORE FURTHER

Gaming at the edge : sexuality and gender at the margins of gamer culture

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/2sp9f6/alma991038598309708681

Gaming at the edge : sexuality and gender at the margins of gamer culture by Adrienne Shaw

EXPLORE FURTHER

Polygamer Podcast

PODCAST

<https://www.polygamer.net/>

Polygamer Podcast

EXPLORE FURTHER

2024 State of the Game Industry

REPORT

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1GfmeYIVkpSuBDue8X5RShlG6sV4DMGK_/view?usp=sharing

EXPLORE FURTHER

Women in Games

WEB SITE

<https://www.womeningames.org/>

Women in Games

EXPLORE FURTHER

10 Games With The Most Inclusive Character Creators

ARTICLE

<https://www.cbr.com/games-with-inclusive-character-creators/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Activision increased representation of women and non-binary people by 2 percentage points as it faces 2025 goal

ARTICLE

<https://www.cnn.com/2023/03/23/activision-increased-representation-of-women-and-non-binary-people-by-2-percentage-points.html>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Activision Blizzard to pay \$54M to settle gender discrimination lawsuit, agrees to ensure 'fair pay and promotion practices'

ARTICLE | [HTTPS://FORTUNE.COM/2023/12/17/ACTIVISION-BLIZZARD-SETTLES-GENDER-DISCRIMINATION-LAWSUIT/](https://fortune.com/2023/12/17/activision-blizzard-settles-gender-discrimination-lawsuit/)

<https://fortune.com/2023/12/17/activision-blizzard-settles-gender-discrimination-lawsuit/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

What do you think about gender inequality in GameDev?

REDDIT THREAD

https://www.reddit.com/r/GirlGamers/comments/1cdxuls/what_do_you_think_about_gender_inequality_in/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Qweerty Gamers

WEB SITE

<https://www.qweertygamers.org/>

Qweerty Gamers

EXPLORE FURTHER

8 Oldest Games With Queer Representation

ARTICLE

<https://www.thegamer.com/oldest-games-queer-lgbtq-representation/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

They found GayBlade! (from Netflix's High Score series)

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cWktGJm60I8&ab_channel=AI%27sRetroGeekLab

They found GayBlade! (from Netflix's High Score series) (or [play GayBlade! in your Web browser on The Internet Archive])

EXPLORE FURTHER

Caper in the Castro - Overview & Analysis of the First LGBT+ Video Game. Built in HyperCard for Mac

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YTm92X47Q00&ab_channel=YesterYear%27sMacGames

Caper in the Castro - Overview & Analysis of the First LGBT+ Video Game. Built in HyperCard for Mac (or [play Caper in the Castro in your Web browser on The Internet Archive])

EXPLORE FURTHER

Tell Me Why

GAME

https://store.steampowered.com/app/1180660/Tell_Me_Why/

Full game (all 3 episodes) on Steam - generally available for free during the month of June

EXPLORE FURTHER

Commentary-free playthrough of Tell Me Why

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D9vr6WYQFVc&ab_channel=Rubhen925

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Kiss That Changed Video Games

ARTICLE

<https://www.newyorker.com/tech/annals-of-technology/the-kiss-that-changed-video-games>